

festival

A Bag Full

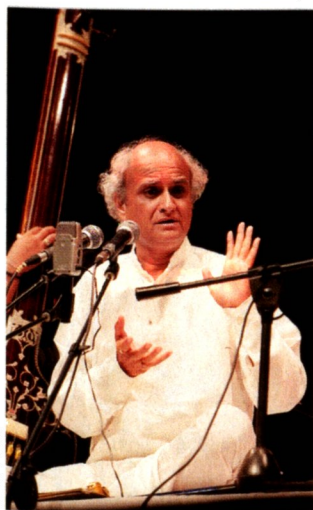
DELHI It is an extravaganza that has been meticulously planned and packaged. The India International Centre Experience is not just another festival of the arts. What distinguishes this annual occasion from others is the wide range of art forms that it presents—from art exhibitions, film screenings, music and dance performances, to theatre and food to keep you busy for a replete, complete seven days.

The festival has expanded over the years to feature various art forms. It starts with a dance performance by Ahmedabad's Kadamb group, which presents Atah Kim. Choreographed by Kathak guru Kumudini Lakhia, it explores the theme, Where Now? It's a question Lakhia keeps asking herself and the performance documents her journey. For those who want to delve deeper into folk traditions, take a look at the exhibition, A Musical Journey Through Rajasthan with Komal Kothari (1929-2004). It focuses on the

musical traditions and instruments of the Langas, Manganiyars and Bhopa communities. Don't miss their accompanying magical performance.

For music lovers, there is a morning concert by the maestro of the Gwalior gharana, Pandit Ulhas Kashalkar. He has an amazing range and depth that very few possess. The festival also witnesses Bharatanatyam dancer Rama Vaidyanathan presenting the Kalindi Katha. She is a vibrant and evolved dancer and that reflects in her choreography. For film buffs the festival includes *Whiskey Galore!*, *The Lady Killers*, *Passport to Pimlico*, and *Divorce: Italian Style*, among others. The week winds down with the screening of *Stay Yet Awhile*, a 120-minute film based on dialogues between Mahatma Gandhi and Rabindranath Tagore. And not to forget, food lovers can savour a new cuisine everyday, from Kashmiri Wazwan to Magyar Vacsora, Gujarati Farsan to Kerala Sadhya. Come on, take the plunge. At IIC from October 16-22. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**

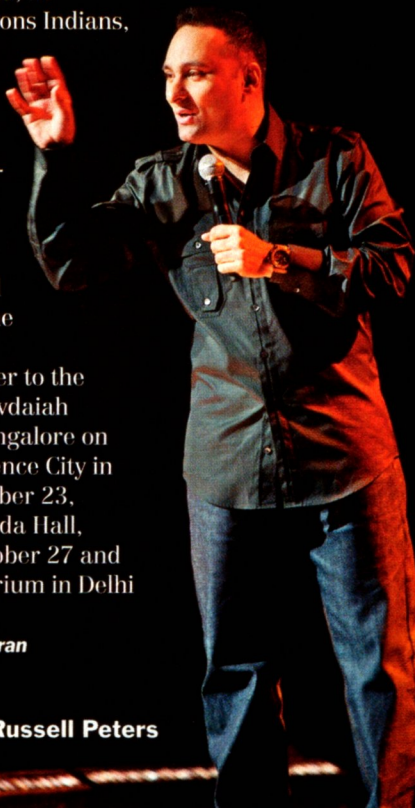
SPECTACULAR: Kashalkar (left) and Vaidyanathan



theatre

Bundle of Laughter

BANGALORE Funny man Russell Peters returns to India again. One of the most popular stand-up artists in the world, his 20th Anniversary Tour features his greatest hits of the past 20 years as well as new material since his last visit. Like other performance artists from across the world, Peters believes in the power of laughter and finds it a great vehicle to address the angst of the modern day citizen. Speaking of immigrant communities around the world, he regularly lampoons Indians, Arabs, Chinese, Filipino, Korean and other South Asian communities and wins himself fans for life. Peters has been nominated four times for the Gemini Awards (Canada's answer to the Emmy). At Chowdaiah Memorial in Bangalore on October 18, Science City in Kolkata on October 23, Shanmukhananda Hall, Mumbai on October 27 and Siri Fort Auditorium in Delhi on October 28. **by Nirmala Ravindran**



JOKES APART: Russell Peters

art exhibition

Odd Angles

DELHI After a break of almost a decade, sculptor Prithpal Singh Ladi is back with his intricately detailed dragonflies, hindless frogs, limp human figures and an antique Mercedes typewriter. His works continue to exhibit his penchant for the eccentric and strange and reflect his constant struggle to come to terms with personal loss



Work by Ladi

far beyond the ordinary. At Gallery Threshold. From October 15 till November 12.